I nodded guiltily. It had only been eleven months ago. I well remembered that time when I hoped I would talk him out of going.

He said, "I wish I had listened to you. Everything you said would happen did happen, and even worse than you said it would."

On that same day I attended the Medical School graduation ceremonies. It was a senior class that I hadn't taught, of course, so I knew no one; and even if I had, I would have found it boring. I avoided graduation ceremonies thereafter.

5

Gertrude finished her driving lessons on June 6, 1950, but her teacher wasn't sure she would be able to pass the test, and Gertrude felt rather disappointed over that. Fortunately, we were slated to go to New York the next day, so there would be time to think it through and decide whether to take more lessons.

On June 8 I visited Fred, got my advance for The Stars, like Dust—, and handed over additional chapters. I also gave him the manuscript of the robot story collection. Martin Greenberg had rejected my notion of calling it Mind and Iron and suggested it be called J, Robot.

"Impossible, Marty," I said. "Eando Binder wrote a short story called 1, Robot' back in 1938."

To which Marty answered, with unassailable logic, "F— Eando Binder."

So I, Robot it was. 1 There is no question that Marty's title was far better than mine and probably helped sell the book.

After that, I went on to see Horace Gold who, as it happened, lived in Stuyvesant Town, so that the visit was an exercise in nostalgia for me.

Gold turned out to be a handsome, talkative fellow who was even balder than my father. (I once casually combed my hair at his mirror and, viewing the process with disfavor, he said, "Do I flex my muscles in your presence?)

His wife, Evelyn, looked rather like Gypsy Rose Lee in my eyes, and seemed quite extroverted.

Horace and I discussed future stories, when suddenly he said, "Pardon me,"